

BACKEND API REFERENCE

SmartStock API Documentation

Complete endpoint reference with authentication, expected input, sample JSON, output, and error behavior.

Project	SmartStock Inventory and Sales Management System
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Document	Backend API Documentation
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Implementation status: 27 REST endpoints implemented, integrated with SQLite, and covered by 45 automated integration tests.

1. API Overview

The SmartStock backend is a REST API built with Node.js and Express. It supports authenticated inventory and sales workflows for a small retail business. SQLite provides persistent storage, while bearer-token sessions and role middleware separate administrator and employee permissions.

Base URL	http://localhost:4000
Content type	application/json
Authentication	Authorization: Bearer <token>
Roles	admin; employee
Database	SQLite through the Node.js node:sqlite module

2. Standard Response Conventions

Successful responses use a success flag and a data object or array.

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": {
    "example": "value"
  }
}
```

Errors use a false success flag and a human-readable message.

```
{
  "success": false,
  "message": "Authentication required"
}
```

3. Endpoint Summary

Method	Endpoint	Access	Purpose
POST	/api/auth/login	Public	Log in
GET	/api/auth/me	Authenticated	Get current user
POST	/api/auth/logout	Authenticated	Log out
POST	/api/auth/register	Admin	Register staff user
GET	/api/products? search=Scarf&category=Accessories	Authenticated	List and search products
GET	/api/products/low-stock	Authenticated	List low-stock products
POST	/api/products	Admin	Create product
PUT	/api/products/1	Admin	Update product
DELETE	/api/products/9	Admin	Delete product
GET	/api/sales	Authenticated	List sales
POST	/api/sales	Admin or Employee	Record sale
GET	/api/sales/report	Authenticated	Get dashboard report
GET	/api/orders	Authenticated	List orders
POST	/api/orders	Admin	Create order
PUT	/api/orders/4	Admin	Update order status
GET	/api/customers	Authenticated	List customers

POST	/api/customers	Admin	Create customer
GET	/api/settings	Authenticated	Get settings
PUT	/api/settings	Admin	Update settings

4. Detailed API Specifications

Authentication

4.1 POST /api/auth/login

Name	Log in
Access	Public
Purpose	Validates user credentials and creates a seven-day authenticated session.
Errors	401 - Incorrect email or password

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "email": "admin@smartstock.com",
  "password": "admin123"
}
```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": {
    "token": "<64-character-token>",
    "user": {
      "id": 1,
      "name": "Alicia Chen",
      "email": "admin@smartstock.com",
      "role": "admin"
    }
  }
}
```

4.2 GET /api/auth/me

Name	Get current user
Access	Authenticated
Purpose	Returns the user associated with the active bearer token.
Errors	401 - Session expired or invalid

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  }
}
```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": {
    "id": 1,
    "name": "Alicia Chen",
    "email": "admin@smartstock.com",
    "role": "admin"
  }
}
```

4.3 POST /api/auth/logout

Name	Log out
Access	Authenticated
Purpose	Deletes the active session token.
Errors	401 - Authentication required

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  }
}
```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": {
    "logged_out": true
  }
}
```

4.4 POST /api/auth/register

Name	Register staff user
Access	Admin
Purpose	Creates an admin or employee account. Passwords must contain at least eight characters.
Errors	400 - Invalid fields or duplicate email; 403 - Insufficient permission

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  },
  "body": {
    "name": "Jordan Lee",
    "email": "jordan@example.com",
    "password": "password123",
    "role": "employee"
  }
}
```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": {
    "id": 3,
    "name": "Jordan Lee",
    "email": "jordan@example.com",
    "role": "employee"
  }
}
```

Products

4.5 GET /api/products?search=Scarf&category=Accessories

Name	List and search products
Access	Authenticated
Purpose	Returns the catalog, optionally filtered by free-text search and exact category.
Errors	401 - Authentication required

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  }
}
```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": [
    {
      "id": 1,
      "sku": "DW-SCF-001",
      "name": "Cloud-Dyed Silk Scarf",
      "origin": "Dali, Yunnan",
      "material": "Mulberry Silk",
      "dye_technique": "Bound Resist",
      "category": "Accessories",
      "price": 48,
      "cost": 19,
      "quantity": 12,
      "low_stock_threshold": 5,
      "created_at": "2026-07-25 21:14:51",
      "updated_at": "2026-07-25 21:14:51"
    }
  ]
}
```

4.6 GET /api/products/low-stock

Name	List low-stock products
Access	Authenticated
Purpose	Returns products whose quantity is less than or equal to their low-stock threshold.
Errors	401 - Authentication required

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  }
}
```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": [
    {
      "id": 1,
      "sku": "DW-SCF-001",
      "name": "Cloud-Dyed Silk Scarf",
      "origin": "Dali, Yunnan",
      "material": "Mulberry Silk",
      "dye_technique": "Bound Resist",
      "category": "Accessories",
      "price": 48,
      "cost": 19,
      "quantity": 4,
      "low_stock_threshold": 5,
      "created_at": "2026-07-25 21:14:51",
      "updated_at": "2026-07-25 21:14:51"
    }
  ]
}
```

4.7 POST /api/products

Name	Create product
Access	Admin
Purpose	Adds a validated product to the catalog. SKU values must be unique.
Errors	400 - Validation error or duplicate SKU; 403 - Insufficient permission

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  },
  "body": {
    "sku": "DW-SCF-001",
    "name": "Cloud-Dyed Silk Scarf",
    "origin": "Dali, Yunnan",
    "material": "Mulberry Silk",
    "dye_technique": "Bound Resist",
    "category": "Accessories",
    "price": 48,
    "cost": 19,
    "quantity": 12,
    "low_stock_threshold": 5
  }
}
```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": {
    "id": 1,
    "sku": "DW-SCF-001",
    "name": "Cloud-Dyed Silk Scarf",
    "origin": "Dali, Yunnan",
    "material": "Mulberry Silk",
    "dye_technique": "Bound Resist",
    "category": "Accessories",
    "price": 48,
    "cost": 19,
    "quantity": 12,
    "low_stock_threshold": 5,
    "created_at": "2026-07-25 21:14:51",
    "updated_at": "2026-07-25 21:14:51"
  }
}
```

4.8 PUT /api/products/1

Name	Update product
Access	Admin
Purpose	Updates all managed fields for an existing product.
Errors	400 - Validation error; 404 - Product not found; 403 - Insufficient permission

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  },
  "body": {
    "sku": "DW-SCF-001",
    "name": "Cloud-Dyed Silk Scarf",
    "origin": "Dali, Yunnan",
    "material": "Mulberry Silk",
    "dye_technique": "Bound Resist",
    "category": "Accessories",
    "price": 52,
    "cost": 19,
    "quantity": 20,
    "low_stock_threshold": 5
  }
}
```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": {
    "id": 1,
    "sku": "DW-SCF-001",
    "name": "Cloud-Dyed Silk Scarf",
    "origin": "Dali, Yunnan",
    "material": "Mulberry Silk",
    "dye_technique": "Bound Resist",
    "category": "Accessories",
    "price": 52,
    "cost": 19,
    "quantity": 20,
    "low_stock_threshold": 5,
    "created_at": "2026-07-25 21:14:51",
    "updated_at": "2026-07-25 21:14:51"
  }
}
```

4.9 DELETE /api/products/9

Name	Delete product
Access	Admin
Purpose	Deletes a product only when it has no sales history.
Errors	404 - Product not found; 409 - Product has sales history; 403 - Insufficient permission

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  }
}
```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": {
    "id": 9
  }
}
```


Sales

4.10 GET /api/sales

Name	List sales
Access	Authenticated
Purpose	Returns sales with product, channel, region, quantity, total, and date information.
Errors	401 - Authentication required

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  }
}
```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": [
    {
      "id": 1,
      "product_id": 1,
      "product_name": "Cloud-Dyed Silk Scarf",
      "sku": "DW-SCF-001",
      "quantity_sold": 2,
      "total_price": 96,
      "destination_region": "Canada",
      "sales_channel": "Online Store",
      "sale_date": "2026-07-25 21:30:00"
    }
  ]
}
```

4.11 POST /api/sales

Name	Record sale
Access	Admin or Employee
Purpose	Records a sale, calculates the total from the server-side product price, and atomically reduces inventory.
Errors	400 - Invalid quantity, product not found, or insufficient stock

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  },
  "body": {
    "product_id": 1,
    "quantity_sold": 2,
    "destination_region": "Canada",
    "sales_channel": "Online Store"
  }
}
```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": {
    "id": 1,
    "product_id": 1,
    "product_name": "Cloud-Dyed Silk Scarf",
    "sku": "DW-SCF-001",
    "quantity_sold": 2,
    "total_price": 96,
    "destination_region": "Canada",
    "sales_channel": "Online Store",
    "sale_date": "2026-07-25 21:30:00"
  }
}
```

4.12 GET /api/sales/report

Name	Get dashboard report
Access	Authenticated
Purpose	Returns aggregated revenue, inventory, order, customer, category, region, and best-seller metrics.
Errors	401 - Authentication required

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  }
}
```

Sample JSON output

```

{
  "success": true,
  "data": {
    "total_revenue": 96,
    "units_sold": 2,
    "sales_count": 1,
    "total_products": 8,
    "total_inventory": 147,
    "inventory_cost": 3475,
    "inventory_retail_value": 8901,
    "low_stock_count": 2,
    "pending_orders": 2,
    "total_customers": 3,
    "best_seller": {
      "name": "Cloud-Dyed Silk Scarf",
      "sku": "DW-SCF-001",
      "units": 2
    },
    "by_category": [
      {
        "category": "Accessories",
        "quantity": 45
      }
    ],
    "by_region": [
      {
        "region": "Canada",
        "revenue": 96,
        "units": 2
      }
    ],
    "monthly": [
      {
        "month": "2026-07",
        "revenue": 96
      }
    ]
  }
}

```

Orders

4.13 GET /api/orders

Name	List orders
Access	Authenticated
Purpose	Returns purchase and international orders ordered by creation date.
Errors	401 - Authentication required

Sample JSON input

```

{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  }
}

```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": [
    {
      "id": 1,
      "supplier": "Online Store",
      "product_name": "Moonfold Cotton Kimono",
      "quantity": 2,
      "status": "In Transit",
      "destination_region": "United Kingdom",
      "order_type": "International",
      "created_at": "2026-07-25 21:14:51"
    }
  ]
}
```

4.14 POST /api/orders

Name	Create order
Access	Admin
Purpose	Creates a purchase or international order record.
Errors	400 - Missing or invalid fields; 403 - Insufficient permission

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  },
  "body": {
    "supplier": "Zhoucheng Indigo Workshop",
    "product_name": "Cloud-Dyed Silk Scarf",
    "quantity": 20,
    "status": "Pending",
    "destination_region": "China",
    "order_type": "Purchase"
  }
}
```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": {
    "id": 4,
    "supplier": "Zhoucheng Indigo Workshop",
    "product_name": "Cloud-Dyed Silk Scarf",
    "quantity": 20,
    "status": "Pending",
    "destination_region": "China",
    "order_type": "Purchase",
    "created_at": "2026-07-25 21:40:00"
  }
}
```

4.15 PUT /api/orders/4

Name	Update order status
Access	Admin

Purpose	Changes an order to Pending, Processing, In Transit, Delivered, or Cancelled.
Errors	400 - Invalid status; 404 - Order not found; 403 - Insufficient permission

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  },
  "body": {
    "status": "In Transit"
  }
}
```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": {
    "id": 4,
    "supplier": "Zhoucheng Indigo Workshop",
    "product_name": "Cloud-Dyed Silk Scarf",
    "quantity": 20,
    "status": "In Transit",
    "destination_region": "China",
    "order_type": "Purchase",
    "created_at": "2026-07-25 21:40:00"
  }
}
```

Customers

4.16 GET /api/customers

Name	List customers
Access	Authenticated
Purpose	Returns customer contact, region, and purchase-total information.
Errors	401 - Authentication required

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  }
}
```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": [
    {
      "id": 1,
      "name": "Mina Patel",
      "email": "mina@example.com",
      "phone": "+1 312 555 0101",
      "region": "United States",
      "total_purchases": 240.5
    }
  ]
}
```

4.17 POST /api/customers

Name	Create customer
Access	Admin
Purpose	Adds a customer to the cross-border customer directory.
Errors	400 - Name or email missing; 403 - Insufficient permission

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  },
  "body": {
    "name": "Amelia Brooks",
    "email": "amelia@example.com",
    "phone": "+44 7700 900123",
    "region": "United Kingdom"
  }
}
```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": {
    "id": 4,
    "name": "Amelia Brooks",
    "email": "amelia@example.com",
    "phone": "+44 7700 900123",
    "region": "United Kingdom",
    "total_purchases": 0
  }
}
```

Settings

4.18 GET /api/settings

Name	Get settings
Access	Authenticated

Purpose	Returns the single workspace settings record.
Errors	401 - Authentication required

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  }
}
```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": {
    "id": 1,
    "store_name": "Indigo Trail Studio",
    "store_email": "ops@indigotrail.com",
    "default_threshold": 5,
    "admin_name": "Alicia Chen",
    "currency": "USD"
  }
}
```

4.19 PUT /api/settings

Name	Update settings
Access	Admin
Purpose	Updates store identity, default stock threshold, administrator, and currency.
Errors	400 - Invalid settings; 403 - Insufficient permission

Sample JSON input

```
{
  "headers": {
    "Authorization": "Bearer <token>"
  },
  "body": {
    "store_name": "Indigo Trail Studio",
    "store_email": "ops@indigotrail.com",
    "default_threshold": 6,
    "admin_name": "Alicia Chen",
    "currency": "USD"
  }
}
```

Sample JSON output

```
{
  "success": true,
  "data": {
    "id": 1,
    "store_name": "Indigo Trail Studio",
    "store_email": "ops@indigotrail.com",
    "default_threshold": 6,
    "admin_name": "Alicia Chen",
    "currency": "USD"
  }
}
```

5. Authentication and Authorization Rules

- Public access is limited to POST /api/auth/login.
- All business endpoints require a valid bearer token.
- Employees can view business data and record sales.
- Administrators can manage products, orders, customers, settings, and staff accounts.
- Session tokens expire seven days after login and are invalidated immediately on logout.

6. Transaction and Validation Rules

- Product SKU values are normalized to uppercase and must be unique.
- Price, cost, quantity, and stock thresholds must be non-negative.
- Sale totals are calculated from the database product price, not from client-submitted totals.
- A sale and its inventory reduction are executed in one database transaction.
- A sale is rejected when requested quantity exceeds available stock.
- A product with sales history cannot be deleted, preserving reporting integrity.